

HeroPips — Business Requirements Document (BRD v1.0)

Product: HeroPips (heropips.com) — AI-assisted trading automation, academy & signal platform **Document type:** Business Requirements Document **Owner:** Founder / CEO · **Business analyst:** Product **Status:** Draft for approval · **Date:** July 24, 2026 **Audience:** Founder, investors/advisors, legal counsel, engineering leadership, finance/ops, key partners

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	Jul 24, 2026	Founder + Product	First end-to-end draft
1.0	—	—	Approved baseline (pending sign-off per §14)

Document hierarchy & traceability: Strategy Plan → **BRD (this doc — the business "why/what")** → PRD v1.0 (product scope & epics E1-E19) → FRD v1.0 (system behavior, FR-xx) → technical specs. Traceability chain: Business Objective (BO-x) → Business Requirement (BR-xx) → PRD Epic (Ex) → Functional Requirement (FR-xx). See Appendix A.

Related documents: HeroPips Investor-Grade Productization & Business Plan (strategy source); HeroPips PRD v1.0; HeroPips FRD v1.0; Legal/Compliance Memo (to be commissioned).

1. Purpose of This Document

This BRD defines the business needs, objectives, scope, revenue model, stakeholders, constraints, rules, and risks for building and launching HeroPips. It is the authoritative statement of **what the business must achieve and why**; it deliberately avoids specifying *how* the system behaves (FRD) or detailed product scope decisions (PRD). Any conflict between documents resolves in this order: BRD business rules → PRD scope → FRD behavior.

2. Executive Summary

HeroPips is a **self-directed, subscription SaaS** that takes retail traders from zero to hero: a structured trading academy and paper trading as the acquisition hook, then broker-agnostic live automation (MetaTrader 5 via MetaAPI, crypto exchanges via CCXT, cTrader at GA), AI-configured signals, TradingView alert execution, and a premium risk-automation suite ("Trade Guard") that enforces the discipline retail and prop-firm traders lack.

The business is **Dubai-based**, targets MENA/India/SEA first, and monetizes through five streams in v1 — tiered subscriptions (Free/\$29/\$79/\$199), a one-time Academy SKU (~\$249), a capped beta-only Lifetime Deal, broker **IB rebates** (volume-based, funds the free

tier), and an affiliate/IB partner program — with white-label licensing and a signal-marketplace take-rate deferred to Phase 3/2 respectively.

Plan of record: Foundation Aug-Sep 2026 → Closed Beta Oct 2026 → Open Beta + monetization Nov 10-Dec 31 2026 → GA Jan 15, 2027. Financial targets: ≥250 paying customers by Dec 31 2026; **\$40k MRR by mid-2027**; ARR ~\$300-500k (Y1) → \$1.5-2.5M (Y2) → \$8-12M (Y3). Strategy: **bootstrap on LTD + Academy + IB rebates**; raise a seed only at ≥\$50-100k MRR with churn ≤6%.

Two business-model decisions are locked as non-negotiable risk controls: **(1)** the consumer referral program defaults to 2 levels, subscription-triggered, non-cash (no 10-level cash MLM); **(2)** there is **no withdrawable bonus wallet** — points are non-cash by construction, and real cash to partners flows only through the KYC'd affiliate/IB rail.

3. Business Context & Background

3.1 Market

Signal	Data point (directional)	Implication
Algorithmic trading market	~\$21-23B (2025), ~13% CAGR to ~\$43B by 2030	Retail automation is the fastest-growing slice; tooling demand is durable
Trading education market	~\$1.35B (2024) → ~\$3.7B (2033)	Education is a credible standalone SKU and a cheap acquisition channel
Prop-firm boom	2,000+ firms; challenge pass rates ~5-10%, mostly rule violations	"Discipline as a service" is an unserved, willingness-to-pay niche
Target geographies	MENA, India, SEA retail forex/crypto communities (Telegram-native)	Incumbents (TradersPost, 3Commas) are US/crypto-centric — open flank

3.2 Competitive gap (summary)

TradersPost/Alertatron = execution plumbing only, no education, weak MT5/MENA focus. 3Commas/Cryptohopper = crypto-only bots. Copy-trading platforms (eToro, ZuluTrade, Darwinex) = no education, no user control, heavy regulation. High-ticket academies = enforcement magnets (FTC's \$362M Online Trading Academy judgment) and no tooling. **No player combines academy + paper trading + broker-agnostic automation + prop-firm risk guards at a mass-market price.** That combination is the wedge and the moat.

3.3 Regulatory backdrop (business-level)

The UAE regulates robo-advisory (SCA → CMA as of Jan 1, 2026); free zones (DIFC/ADGM) offer credible structures and sandboxes. MLM/pyramid statutes globally punish recruitment-driven compensation; money transmission rules capture withdrawable stored value. **Business consequence:** HeroPips must be positioned and built as a *self-directed*

software tool — no advice, no custody, no discretionary trading, compliant referral design — with counsel engaged before Open Beta. (Enforced product-side via PRD §16 / FRD compliance module.)

4. Business Objectives & Success Criteria

ID	Objective (SMART)	KPI & target	Measure by	Owner
BO-1	Prove activation of the zero-to-hero funnel	≥40% of signups place first (paper or live) trade within 24h	GA+90 (Apr 2027); ≥30% by Closed Beta review (Oct 31, 2026)	Product
BO-2	Prove willingness to pay	≥250 paying customers (subs + LTD) by Dec 31, 2026; free→paid ≥3% by GA+90	M4 / M6	Founder
BO-3	Build durable recurring revenue	\$40k MRR by Jun 2027; monthly logo churn ≤6%	Monthly from GA	Founder/Finance
BO-4	Monetize non-paying users via broker economics	≥\$10k/month IB rebate revenue by Q2 2027; ≥2 broker IB agreements signed by M3	Quarterly	Founder/BD
BO-5	Make risk automation the retention moat	≥60% of live-connected users run ≥1 active guard; guarded cohort churns ≥30% less	GA+90 cohort analysis	Product
BO-6	Ship a legally clean viral loop	Referral K-factor ≥0.3 in beta with ≤2-level, non-cash-default program; zero compliance escalations	M4	Growth + Compliance
BO-7	Launch clean	Counsel sign-off on compliance controls C1-C7 before GA; zero regulatory findings; zero sev-1 in final 2 beta weeks	M5 gate	Founder/Legal
BO-8	Protect unit economics	Blended gross margin ≥55% by GA+180; MetaAPI cost per connected account tracked and ≤\$15	GA+180	Finance/Eng

North-star metric: Weekly Guarded Live Traders (users with ≥ 1 live order passing ≥ 1 guard per week) — it compounds activation (BO-1), monetization (BO-3), and retention (BO-5).

5. Business Scope

5.1 In scope (business capabilities, v1 through GA)

#	Capability	Phase
S1	Beginner trading academy with quizzes, certificates, and paid full curriculum	Phase 0 → GA
S2	Paper trading with full parity to live trading	Phase 0
S3	Live connectivity: MT5 (MetaAPI) → crypto CEX (CCXT: Binance, Bybit) → cTrader	Phase 0 → GA
S4	Local mirroring of balances, positions, orders, and history (trusted record)	Phase 0
S5	Signal engine: predefined library + user-configured instances + AI trade tips	Closed Beta
S6	TradingView webhook → broker execution (idempotent, guarded)	Closed Beta
S7	Risk-automation suite (basic free; premium paid; prop-firm presets Elite)	Closed Beta → GA
S8	Runtime signal backtesting (Pro+) on 1–15y historical data store	GA
S9	Monetization: 4 tiers, annual plans, Academy SKU, capped LTD, entitlements	Open Beta
S10	IB rebate revenue rail with mandatory disclosure	Open Beta
S11	Consumer referral (2-level default, credits) + points gamification (non-cash)	Closed Beta
S12	Affiliate/IB partner engine: per-deal configs, sub-IB (≤ 3 deep), double-entry ledger, KYC payouts	Open Beta → GA
S13	Admin console: config-driven plans, flags, branding, signals, compliance flags, audit	Phase 0 → continuous
S14	ROI share cards + curated signal lists (follow-lite)	Open Beta
S15	Multi-tenant-ready architecture (tenant_id + config-driven branding) — no external tenants yet	Phase 0 (architecture)

5.2 Out of business scope for v1 (with rationale)

#	Exclusion	Business rationale
X1	Investment advice, discretionary trading, "profitable signal" claims	Licensing exposure (robo-advisory), enforcement precedent, brand integrity
X2	Custody of user funds; withdrawable bonus/points wallet	Money-transmission/e-money licensing; unacceptable at seed stage
X3	10-level or cash-based consumer referral	Pyramid/MLM statute exposure; reputational risk with VCs, banks, app stores
X4	White-label tenant onboarding	Pre-PMF distraction; requires ≥ 3 committed leads + Phase 3 resourcing
X5	Full backtesting engine; mobile native apps; MT4	Build cost vs beta deadline; Phase 2/3 items
X6	High-ticket (\$1k+) education programs	FTC/OTA-style enforcement magnet; conflicts with mass-market positioning

6. Stakeholders & RACI

Stakeholder	Interest	R/A/C/I on key decisions
Founder/CEO	Vision, funding, pricing, partnerships	A on pricing, releases, deals; R on fundraising/BD
Engineering lead (+2-3 engineers/contractors)	Delivery, reliability, security	R on build; C on scope; A on architecture
Product/BA	Scope, metrics, this document set	R on PRD/FRD; C on pricing
Content/Academy lead	Curriculum, certificates	R on E2 content
External counsel (UAE + consumer)	Structure, ToS, disclaimers, referral/AI review	C mandatory on C1-C7, referral config, LTD terms; A on legal sign-offs
Finance/Ops (part-time)	Billing, payouts, ledger integrity, KYC	R on payouts; A on payout approvals
Support	User trust, incident comms	R on tickets; I on releases
Affiliates/IB partners (e.g., persona Sana)	Deal economics, reliable payouts	C on partner features; I on policy
Brokers (Exness/IC Markets/Vantage-class)	Referred volume	C on IB integration formats
End users (personas P1-P5)	Value, safety, trust	I ; represented via beta councils
Regulators (SCA/CMA, DFSA/FSRA context)	Consumer protection	I via counsel; drive constraints

Decision gates requiring named sign-off: pricing changes (Founder + Finance), referral depth/cash changes (Compliance role + counsel), compliance country flags (Compliance), releases M0-M5 (Founder + Eng lead), partner payouts (Finance/Ops).

7. Business Model & Financial Analysis

7.1 Revenue streams

#	Stream	Mechanics	Phase	Primary KPI
R1	SaaS subscriptions	Free / Starter \$29 / Pro \$79 / Elite \$199 monthly; annual –20%	Open Beta	MRR, churn
R2	Academy SKU	"Zero-to-Hero" one-time ~\$249 (\$199–\$299 A/B); free with annual Pro/Elite	Open Beta	Attach rate
R3	Lifetime Deal (beta only)	\$499–\$799, hard cap 500 seats, Pro-Lifetime entitlement; never repeated	Open Beta	Seats sold, cash
R4	IB broker rebates	Volume-based per-lot rebates on referred broker accounts (typ. \$4–\$8/lot tiered); disclosed	Open Beta	\$/month rebates
R5	Affiliate-driven growth	Not revenue itself; per-deal rev-share/CPA/rebate-pass-through drives R1–R4 volume	Open Beta	Partner-attributed MRR
R6	Signal marketplace take-rate (20%)	Publishers sell configs; platform keeps 20%	Phase 2	GMV, take
R7	White-label licensing	~\$5k setup + \$2–3k/month + rev share per tenant	Phase 3	Tenants, tenant MRR

7.2 Unit economics (per paying user, monthly — planning figures)

Assumes blended MetaAPI cost ≈ \$10 per connected live MT5 account; CCXT (crypto) ≈ \$0 per account; infra/AI/email allocation shown.

Tier	Price	Max live conns	Est. variable cost	Gross profit	GM%
Free	\$0	0 (paper only)	~\$0.3 infra	–\$0.3	n/a (funded by R4 + conversion)
Starter	\$29	1	~\$12 (\$10 MetaAPI + \$2)	~\$17	~59%
Pro	\$79	3	~\$35 (\$30 + \$5)	~\$44	~56%
Elite	\$199	10	~\$110 (\$100 + \$10)	~\$89	~45%

Business consequences (binding): live connections are never free (BRL-01); MetaAPI spend is tracked per account with idle auto-sleep as fast-follow; a **self-hosted MT5 bridge** is

planned in Phase 3 once connected accounts pass ~1,000, lifting blended GM toward ~85%; crypto-first users are margin-accretive and prioritized in growth targeting.

7.3 Cost structure (planning estimates — validate before board use)

Bucket	Estimate	Notes
Build (Aug 2026 → GA Jan 2027)	~\$150–250k	Founder + eng lead + 2–3 contractors + content creator; lean Dubai/remote rates
Legal & compliance	~\$25–40k	UAE structure, ToS/disclaimers, referral & AI-tips review, LTD terms, DPAs
Infra & tooling (beta)	<\$1k/month fixed	Hetzner + Vercel + SendGrid + KMS + Sentry + PostHog; excludes MetaAPI variable
MetaAPI variable	~\$10/connected account/mo	Dominant COGS; telemetry per BO-8
Marketing (beta)	~\$10–20k	Seeded affiliates, community, creative; growth is referral/IB-led by design

7.4 Three-year projection (base case; assumptions: 3% free→paid, 6% monthly churn, blended paid ARPU ~\$55)

Metric	Y1 (through 2027 H1)	Y2	Y3
Registered users	~15,000	~80,000	~300,000
Paying customers	~450 (+ LTD ≤500)	~3,000	~12,000
Subscription ARR	~\$300–500k	~\$1.5–2.5M	~\$8–12M (incl. R6/R7)
IB rebate revenue	ramp → \$10k/mo	\$20–40k/mo	scale with volume
Blended GM	~55%	~55–60%	~70%+ (self-host bridge)

Break-even logic: at \$40k MRR × ~55% GM ≈ \$22k/month gross profit + IB rebates ≥ \$10k/month against a lean opex base — operating break-even is targeted during 2027 without external capital. **Funding posture:** LTD + Academy + rebates fund the runway; a seed raise is triggered only at ≥\$50–100k MRR with churn ≤6% and proven activation (see Strategy Plan §13).

7.5 Cost of doing nothing / delay

Every quarter of delay: (a) the TradersPost-class players localize toward MENA/India, (b) 500-seat LTD cash and beta-cohort testimonials are lost to competitors' communities, (c) IB relationships (exclusive-ish regional deals) get signed by others. The December 2026 beta deadline is therefore a **business constraint**, not an engineering preference.

8. Current State vs Future State

Dimension	As-is (user's world today)	To-be (with HeroPips)	Business value
Learning	YouTube fragments, predatory courses, Telegram "gurus"	Structured free→paid academy with quiz gating and practice deep-links	Cheap acquisition, trust, churn-reducing habit
Practice	Broker demo accounts disconnected from learning	Paper trading with full live-ticket parity + leaderboards	Activation engine; safe automation rehearsal
Execution	Manual trading of TradingView alerts; copy-paste into MT5	Webhook → guarded order in seconds, exactly once	Core paid utility; latency = value
Signals	Paid Telegram signals, opaque and unaccountable	Transparent predefined strategies + user-owned configurations + AI tips	Differentiation without advice liability
Discipline	Willpower; blown daily limits; failed prop challenges	Server-side Trade Guard suite, fail-closed	Retention moat; Elite tier justification
Records	Scattered broker statements	Local mirror of every balance/position/order/deal + journal	Trust, analytics, marketplace foundation
Partner economics	Ad-hoc IB spreadsheets	Configurable deals, sub-IB, double-entry ledger, KYC payouts	Scalable, audit-proof growth channel
Operations	Hard-coded business rules	Admin-config everything (plans, flags, branding, compliance)	Speed without deploys; white-label option value

9. Business Requirements

Convention: **BR-xx**, MoSCoW priority, measurable acceptance at business level, mapped to PRD epics. "The business requires..." statements; system behavior lives in the FRD.

9.1 Acquisition, education & activation

ID	Business requirement	Priority	Business acceptance measure	PRD map
BR-01	Convert an unknown beginner into an activated practice trader within one session, via a guided learn→quiz→paper-trade path	Must	≥40% activation in 24h (BO-1); path completion instrumented end-to-end	E1, E2, E3
BR-02	Offer a genuinely valuable free tier (core lessons, paper trading, delayed signal viewing) that costs near-zero to serve and creates a measured paywall moment	Must	Free-tier COGS <\$0.5/user/mo; paywall_viewed→checkout conversion tracked	E2, E3, E7.5
BR-03	Sell a full academy curriculum as a standalone SKU and as an annual-plan sweetener	Should	Academy attach ≥10% of paid; A/B price \$199-\$299 concluded by M5	E2, E15
BR-04	Provide shareable, disclaimed proof-of-progress assets (certificates, ROI cards) that carry referral links	Must	K-factor ≥0.3 (BO-6); share→signup tracked via UTM	E2.6, E11.1, E13

9.2 Connectivity, automation & trust

ID	Business requirement	Priority	Business acceptance measure	PRD map
BR-05	Let a paying user connect their own MT5 account in minutes and see their true balance/positions/history inside HeroPips	Must	Connect→synchronized ≤3 min p90; connect success ≥85%	E4, E5
BR-06	Support crypto exchanges (Binance, Bybit) with trade/read-only keys, and cTrader by GA, behind one venue-agnostic abstraction	Must (CEX) / Should (cTrader)	2 CEX live by M3; cTrader v1 by M5; zero withdrawal-scope keys ever stored	E4
BR-07	Execute TradingView alerts as real orders within seconds, exactly once, always through the risk layer	Must	p95 alert→submit ≤3s; duplicate-execution incidents = 0	E8, E9
BR-08	Offer signals strictly as user-owned configurable tools (predefined library + builder), never as recommendations; AI limited to educational tips	Must	Counsel sign-off (Q4); every surface disclaimed (C1/C2)	E7, §16
BR-09	Make every automated action transparent: notify, log, and journal every order, block, and guard trigger	Must	100% of automated actions notified + auditable; "black box" complaints ≤2% of tickets	E6.4, E17, E18
BR-10	Maintain a complete local mirror (trusted record) of connected-account state and up to 5y history, retained ≥7y	Must	Reconciliation drift resolved ≤5 min; anomaly rate <0.5% of events	E5

9.3 Risk & retention

ID	Business requirement	Priority	Business acceptance measure	PRD map
BR-11	Productize trading discipline: sizing, daily-loss breaker, drawdown watchdog free-to-paid ladder, with premium depth (news/session filters, trailing, partial TP, stale-order cancel, slippage cap)	Must	≥60% guard adoption among live users (BO-5)	E9
BR-12	The live execution path must fail closed — no unguarded live order may ever reach a broker on component failure	Must (non-negotiable)	Chaos tests pass at M1; unguarded-order incidents = 0	E9.6
BR-13	Sell prop-firm challenge protection as an Elite differentiator (generic presets pending trademark review)	Should	Elite conversion attributable to presets ≥25% of Elite signups	E9.10
BR-14	Monetize validation: runtime signal backtesting exclusive to Pro+ at GA, on a 1-15y historical data store	Must (GA)	Backtest usage correlates with upgrade/retention; quota abuse = 0	E10

9.4 Monetization & partner economics

ID	Business requirement	Priority	Business acceptance measure	PRD map
BR-15	Enforce all packaging server-side via a config-driven plan catalog; business can change plans/limits/flags without deploys	Must	Plan change → live ≤60s; zero client-side-only gates in pen test	E7, E15, E16
BR-16	Run a capped, never-repeated Lifetime Deal during Open Beta to fund runway and seed testimonials	Must (window-bound)	≤500 seats enforced by hard counter; LTD terms counsel-reviewed	E15.2
BR-17	Earn IB rebates on referred broker volume with explicit user disclosure; ≥2 broker agreements by M3	Must	≥\$10k/mo by Q2 2027 (BO-4); disclosure present on 100% of broker-link flows	§7.2, C7
BR-18	Operate a consumer referral program that is viral yet compliant: subscription-triggered, two-sided credits, default 2 levels, non-cash; deeper/cash configs technically possible but locked behind Compliance-role legal sign-off	Must	K ≥0.3; zero uncontrolled config changes (audit-verified)	E13
BR-19	Operate a professional affiliate/IB engine with per-deal configurable economics (rev-share/CPA/rebate pass-through, tiers), sub-IB hierarchies ≤3 deep, and a double-entry ledger as the single source of truth for partner money	Must	Ledger always balances (debits=credits); payout disputes <1%; partner-attributed MRR ≥30% by GA+90	E14
BR-20	Reward engagement with points that are non-cash and non-withdrawable by construction; cash reaches third parties only through the KYC'd affiliate rail	Must (non-negotiable)	Zero "withdraw points" capability exists; counsel sign-off	E12, C4

9.5 Compliance, operations & platform

ID	Business requirement	Priority	Business acceptance measure	PRD map
BR-21	Position and operate as a self-directed software tool: no advice, no custody, no discretionary trading; full-auto requires informed consent + an active drawdown guard	Must (non-negotiable)	Counsel sign-off on C1-C7 before GA (BO-7)	§16, E7.8
BR-22	Gate features per jurisdiction from admin config (e.g., US blocked from signals/auto-trade at launch) without deploys	Must	Country flags effective ≤60s; launch block-list applied at M1	C6, E16
BR-23	Every order action, admin action, and config change is audit-logged (who/what/before/after) and retained	Must	100% coverage verified in pen test; audit log immutable	E16.1
BR-24	The platform is white-label-ready from day 1 (tenant-scoped data, config-driven branding) so Phase 3 licensing requires no re-architecture; no external tenants before Phase 3 + ≥3 committed leads	Must (architecture) / Won't (onboarding, v1)	CI gate: zero hard-coded brand strings; RLS isolation test passes	E19
BR-25	Instrument the full funnel and unit costs (PostHog events + MetaAPI per-account spend) so weekly beta decisions are data-driven	Must	Weekly metrics review operating from M1; cost per account visible per user	§13, E16.5
BR-26	Meet trust thresholds: 99.5% beta / 99.9% GA availability on the execution path; public status page from Open Beta; annual pen test before GA	Must	SLO dashboards green; pen test passed at M5	§10

10. Business Rules (binding policy — enforced in product per FRD)

ID	Rule
BRL-01	Live broker/exchange connection is never available on the Free tier.
BRL-02	Points/credits are non-cash, non-transferable, non-withdrawable; they expire after 12 months of inactivity; ToS states they have no monetary value.
BRL-03	Consumer referral: default depth 2; rewards only on genuine first payments (14-day refund hold); any depth >2 or cash reward requires Compliance-role sign-off recorded in the audit log.
BRL-04	Full-auto execution requires versioned informed consent, re-confirmed every 90 days, and an active drawdown guard on the target account.
BRL-05	Exchange API keys with withdrawal permission are rejected at validation and never stored; MT5 investor passwords are rejected for trading connections.
BRL-06	The Lifetime Deal is capped at 500 seats globally, enforced by an atomic counter, and is never offered after GA.
BRL-07	The live execution path fails closed; paper may fail open with a warning.
BRL-08	Any broker-link/IB flow displays the compensation disclosure before account linkage.
BRL-09	No UI or marketing surface may state or imply guaranteed profit; all performance is labeled hypothetical or historical with the standard disclaimer component.
BRL-10	HeroPips never holds user fiat or crypto balances; partner cash payouts occur only after KYC, monthly, above a \$50 threshold, with clawback on refund.
BRL-11	Scope change control: any post-approval addition requires an equal removal ("one-in-one-out") and Founder + Eng-lead sign-off with milestone impact stated.

11. Constraints, Dependencies & Assumptions

Constraints: beta must end Dec 31, 2026 (founder commitment; drives all scope calls) · lean budget per §7.3 · mandated stack (Node/NestJS, Next.js, PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, Redis→Kafka path, Docker, Vercel/Hetzner, MetaAPI, CCXT, SendGrid) · Dubai/UAE base entity · English-only at launch (AR/HI Phase 2) · responsive web only.

External dependencies: MetaAPI availability & pricing quote (Open Q1) · Stripe availability for the UAE entity, fallback PSP (Open Q3 — blocks M3) · counsel deliverables before Open Beta (Q4/Q5) · economic-calendar feed license (Q7) · historical data sources

(Dukascopy FX, Binance dumps) · broker IB agreements (≥2 by M3) · TradingView webhook behavior (no signing headers — mitigated per FRD-09).

Assumptions (to validate in beta): 3% free→paid and 6% monthly churn are achievable in this segment · blended paid ARPU ≈ \$55 · Telegram/community channels in target geos are reachable at low CAC · MetaAPI blended cost ≈ \$10/account holds at volume · demand ranking MT5 > CEX > cTrader holds (Q2 checks this) · LTD demand exists at \$499–\$799 (Q8).

12. Business Risk Register (top-level; product mitigations in PRD §16)

Risk	L×I	Business mitigation	Owner
Regulatory reclassification (advice/robo/custody)	M×H	Self-directed positioning (BR-21); counsel gate at M5; country flags (BR-22); strip AI to analysis if challenged	Founder/Legal
Referral read as MLM by platforms, banks, or regulators	M×H	BRL-03 defaults; Compliance-gated config; non-cash rewards	Compliance
MetaAPI cost/pricing shift destroys margin	M×H	BRL-01 gating; per-account telemetry (BO-8); self-hosted bridge trigger at ~1k accounts	Eng/Finance
Retail churn (losing traders quit) exceeds 8%	H×H	Guards+academy+journal as stickiness (BR-11); annual plans; pivot harder to IB-rebate economics if breached	Product
Payment rails unavailable/fragile for UAE entity	M×H	Q3 resolved before M3; fallback PSP + USDT payout rail for partners	Finance
Automation incident (unguarded/duplicate order) harms a user	L×H	BR-12 fail-closed; idempotency; chaos tests at M1; incident comms runbook	Eng
LTD overhang (lifetime users unprofitable at scale)	M×M	Hard cap 500; fair-use limits; never repeated (BRL-06)	Founder
Partner-ledger dispute or payout error damages the growth channel	L×H	Double-entry ledger (BR-19); payout approval queue; balance-check blocks payouts	Finance/Ops
Key-person/team bandwidth vs Dec date	H×M	One-in-one-out rule (BRL-11); contractor bench; Phase-2 deferrals pre-agreed	Founder

Risk appetite statement: the business accepts aggressive *commercial* risk (pricing experiments, LTD, geo focus) and near-zero *compliance and fund-safety* risk (BR-12, BR-20, BR-21 are non-negotiable).

13. Business Acceptance & Launch Criteria (go/no-go, mirrors PRD §15)

Gate	Date	Business criteria
M0 Foundation	Sep 30, 2026	E2E demo on 3 real broker accounts; academy v0 + paper live; entitlements enforced
M1 Closed Beta	Oct 1, 2026	500 invites out; chaos tests (idempotency, fail-closed) passed
M2 Beta review	Oct 31, 2026	Activation ≥30%; guard creation ≥60% of connected; NPS ≥30
M3 Monetization on	Nov 10, 2026	Payments live; LTD counter live; 2 CEX; affiliate portal v1; ≥2 IB agreements signed
M4 Beta end	Dec 31, 2026	≥8k registered; ≥250 paying; 0 sev-1 in final 2 weeks
M5 GA	Jan 15, 2027	Counsel sign-off C1-C7; pen test passed; pricing finalized from beta data
M6 GA+90	Apr 2027	≥3% free→paid; MRR on \$40k-by-mid-2027 trajectory; guard-churn delta measured

14. Governance, Approval & Change Control

Approvals required on this BRD: Founder/CEO (business owner) · Engineering lead (feasibility) · External counsel (sections 3.3, 9.5, 10, 12) · Finance/Ops (section 7). Review cadence: weekly metric review during beta (BR-25); BRD re-baseline only at M2 and M4 checkpoints. Change control per BRL-11; all changes logged in the version table with milestone impact.

15. Glossary

IB = Introducing Broker (broker pays volume-based rebates for referred accounts) · LTD = Lifetime Deal · Guard = server-side risk rule in the execution path · Fail-closed = block live orders on component failure · Entitlement = server-enforced capability derived from plan · Tenant = a branded platform instance (HeroPips = tenant #1) · K-factor = invites per user × conversion of invites · GM = gross margin · North-star = Weekly Guarded Live Traders.

Appendix A — Traceability Matrix (BO ↔ BR ↔ PRD Epic)

BO	Supported by BRs	PRD epics
BO-1 Activation	BR-01, BR-02, BR-04, BR-05	E1-E5
BO-2 Willingness to pay	BR-02, BR-03, BR-14, BR-15, BR-16	E2, E7, E10, E15
BO-3 Recurring revenue	BR-11, BR-14, BR-15, BR-19	E9, E10, E14, E15
BO-4 IB rebates	BR-17, BR-19	§7.2, E14
BO-5 Retention moat	BR-09, BR-11, BR-12, BR-13	E6, E9, E17, E18
BO-6 Viral loop	BR-04, BR-18, BR-20	E11-E13
BO-7 Clean launch	BR-21, BR-22, BR-23, BR-26	§16, E16
BO-8 Unit economics	BR-02, BR-15, BR-17, BR-24, BR-25	E4.4, E7, E16.5, E19

Appendix B — KPI Dictionary (measurement source of truth)

Activation = signup AND (paper funded OR broker connected) AND first order ≤24h (PostHog funnel) · Free→paid = paying subs ÷ registered, trailing 30d (Stripe+DB) · Churn = cancelled paid logos ÷ opening paid logos, monthly (Stripe) · K-factor = referred signups per active user per month × referred-signup→active rate (referral edges + events) · Guard adoption = live-connected users with ≥1 active guard ÷ live-connected users (DB) · IB rebate revenue = broker statements reconciled into ledger, monthly (E14.5) · MetaAPI cost/account = provider invoice ÷ avg connected accounts (billing export + telemetry) · North-star = distinct users with ≥1 live order passing ≥1 guard, weekly (order+guard events).

— End of BRD v1.0 —